OH DEAR DRAGON! - Game Narrative

Summary

OH DEAR DRAGON! is a medieval-futurist fantasy game set in a kingdom where the Middle Ages never truly disappeared, instead, they simply evolved. Ancient castles, royal bloodlines, knights, and dragons still exist, but over centuries the world has been gradually transformed by advanced technology. Stone walls now glow with neon light, gothic towers are lined with cables and machinery, and old royal halls hide systems far older and more powerful than the kingdom itself fully understands.

At first glance, the story appears to be a classic fairy tale: a princess has been captured by a dragon, and a brave knight must enter the castle, defeat the beast, and bring her home. But beneath that familiar setup lies a much darker truth. The dragon is not simply a monster, the princess is far from helpless, and the rescue itself may be the beginning of something far worse.

The World

The kingdom was founded in a true medieval age and has survived into an era of highly advanced technology without losing its original structure. The castle at the center of the story is the old lodging of the royal family left empty centuries ago and now it's occupied by the dragon. Aesthetically, it is a real medieval fortress that has been renovated, expanded, and technologically upgraded over generations. Ancient stone corridors now hide surveillance systems, gates respond to hidden protocols, and the castle itself functions as both a historical monument and a machine.

This creates a world where feudal tradition and futuristic systems coexist naturally. Crowns, knights, dragons, and castles still carry symbolic meaning, but real power is hidden much deeper beneath the surface.

The Hidden Truth of the old Castle

Beneath the old royal castle lies the Throne Core, an ancient intelligence created to do what no ruler should ever be able to do: know the future.

Built by a visionary inventor on the principle that every event can be determined if all variables are known (***Laplace's Demon***), the Core was designed as a perfect engine of calculation. It does not merely advise, estimate, or simulate. At full function, it can trace the causal structure of the

kingdom so completely that it can foresee outcomes before they occur. Betrayal, unrest, war, succession, collapse, all become visible to it in advance.

When its creator understood what had been built, they realized the Core was too dangerous to remain in any ruler's hands. A monarchy with access to such a system would no longer govern by law, diplomacy, or trust, but by preemption and absolute control. So the Core was buried deep beneath the castle, sealed behind divided access, and hidden beneath generations of architecture, ritual, and forgetting.

The kingdom continued above it, ruled in the ordinary visible ways of crowns, courts, and armies. But beneath the throne remained the one machine capable of turning royal power into something far more terrifying: certainty.

To prevent absolute power from falling into one set of hands, access to it was divided between two living keys:

- the Key of Sovereignty, belonging to the royal bloodline
- the Key of Custody, bound to the dragon linked to the castle

Neither can open the Core alone. Both are necessary.

CHARACTERS

The Dragon

The dragon is not merely a legendary beast living in the upper reaches of the castle. In truth, he is an ancient creature who was bound to the royal line centuries ago and forced into the role of guardian and custodian of the Throne Core. Over time, he became less a ruler of his own kind and more a living instrument of the crown, a prisoner hidden beneath the image of a monster.

He has lived long enough to watch the kingdom change, adapt, decay, and modernize around him. He is dangerous, intelligent, and deeply weary of royal power.

What he truly wants is not conquest, it is freedom.

Because the princess carries the Key of Sovereignty, she is the only one who can help him unlock the Core and break the ancient bond that enslaves him to the royal bloodline.

The Princess

To the kingdom, the princess is the perfect royal figure: graceful, elegant, beautiful, and seemingly innocent. She appears to be the classic fairy-tale heroine, the one who must be saved.

In reality, she is calculating, ambitious, and far more dangerous than anyone expects.

Although she is already royalty, she understands that being a princess does not mean possessing true control. She has status, image, ceremony, and dynastic importance, but she is still constrained by the king, the court, and the traditions that reduce her to a symbol rather than a force.

She does not want to inherit a title. She wants to inherit power itself.

Once she learns of the Throne Core, she realizes it is the only way to transform her symbolic authority into absolute rule. But because the dragon holds the Key of Custody, she cannot reach it alone. She needs him just as much as he needs her.

Why the Dragon Took the Princess

The official story told by the kingdom is simple: the dragon kidnapped the princess. But the truth is more complicated.

The dragon discovered that the princess had begun investigating the castle's deepest secrets and had learned enough to begin seeking the Throne Core for herself. Realizing how dangerous her ambition could become, he removed her from the court and brought her into his own domain, the old royal castle, intending to contain the threat and prevent the kingdom from regaining access to her too easily.

However, the princess quickly understood that being near the dragon also meant being near the second key she needed.

So what began as a capture became a silent negotiation:

- The dragon wanted to use the princess to gain his freedom.
- The princess wanted to use the dragon to gain the Core.

Both needed the other. Neither trusted the other.

The Knight

The protagonist enters this conflict as the only one who still believes in the old story.

He is a knight in the purest sense: brave, sincere, loyal, and ready to risk everything for what he believes is right. When the kingdom declares that the princess has been taken by the dragon, he steps forward without hesitation. To him, the mission is clear: enter the castle, save the princess, defeat the dragon, and restore order.

He does not realize that he is walking into a struggle far older and more complicated than the kingdom's official version suggests.

This is what gives the story its central irony: the knight is not a fool, but he is the only one still acting as if this were a fairy tale.

And because of that, he becomes extremely useful to everyone else.

Narrative Structure

First Playthrough: The Fairy Tale

On the first playthrough, the story is experienced as a classic rescue quest.

The player believes:

- the princess is a victim
- the dragon is the villain
- the knight is the hero
- saving her will resolve the conflict

The castle, however, quietly suggests otherwise. Hidden systems, sealed routes, strange reactions from the environment, and unsettling moments with both the princess and the dragon all hint that the story is not as simple as it seems.

By the end of the first journey, the knight succeeds in what appears to be his mission: he reaches the princess, confronts the dragon, and escapes with her.

But instead of relief, gratitude, or joy, the princess shows only a cold and unreadable expression.

The rescue feels wrong.

That is where the fairy tale begins to crack.

Second Playthrough: The Truth

On a second playthrough, the story is recontextualized.

The player begins to discover:

- the dragon is enslaved to the royal bloodline
- the princess already knew about the Core
- both were using each other for different ends
- the castle's access systems were built around their mutual dependency

- the knight's rescue did not solve the situation, it disrupted a fragile balance

What first appeared to be a heroic act now looks like something far more dangerous: an intervention that may have helped the princess move closer to the power she wanted all along.

The second playthrough does not erase the first. It reveals what was hidden inside it.

Ending

In the final part of the story, the knight understands the real danger. The princess wants certainty because she fears weakness. The kingdom wanted certainty because it feared chaos. But the Core gives certainty by destroying freedom. So the real enemy is not only the princess or the dragon - it is the idea of absolute control itself.

So the knight's final heroic act is not rescue, but refusal.

He refuses the old fairy tale, the monarchy's hidden logic, the princess's ambition and the idea that the future should belong to just one single person.

True Ending

The knight destroys or permanently seals the Throne Core, breaking the dragon's bond and denying the princess access to absolute power.

- the dragon is finally free
- the princess is defeated, exposed, or left powerless
- the knight walks away having chosen an uncertain but honest future

Other endings

1. Princess ending: The knight hesitates or sides with her. She claims the Core and becomes an all-seeing ruler.
2. Dragon ending: The knight frees the dragon by giving him access, but the Core remains active in some form. The dragon leaves, but the machine still exists.

Main themes

Theme	Meaning in the story
Appearance vs reality	Characters are not what they first seem to be.
Power vs freedom	The Core offers control, but it destroys choice.
Symbol vs truth	A fairy-tale rescue can hide a deeper political danger.
Failure of the fairy tale	The old heroic story is too simple for the real conflict.

Tone note: The game should feel playful on the surface, with irony and style, but darker underneath. It should feel like a fairy tale that smiles at the player while hiding something uncomfortable below.